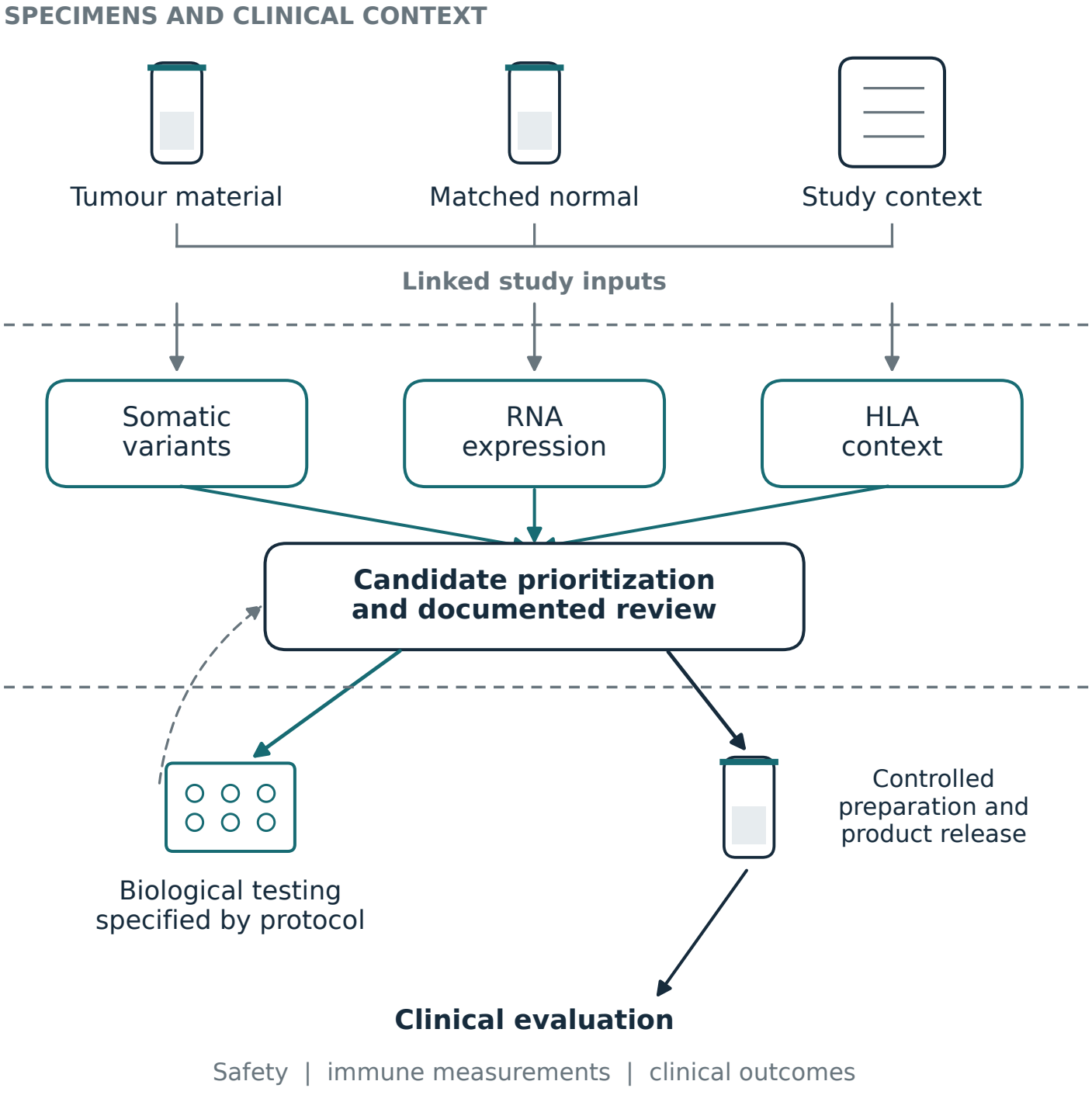The boundaries of a personalized research workflow